Unfortunately, developments are proceeding in another direction. Take for example, the unprecedented pressure and terror to which the government of Nicaragua, which has been lawfully elected, has been subjected. I will be frank—the things the U.S. has done lately make us wary. It seems that just now a shift [in U.S. policies] is exacerbating regional problems. Such an approach does not facilitate finding a common language and complicates the search for political solutions.

With regard to Afghanistan, one gets the impression that the United States side intentionally fails to notice the open door leading to a political settlement. Now there is even a working formula for such a settlement. It's important not to hinder the negotiations in progress but to help them along. In that event a fair settlement will definitely be found.

Mr. President, I would like for you to view my letter as another one of our "fireside chats." I would sincerely like not only to keep the warmth of our Geneva meetings but also move further in the development of our dialogue. I look at correspondence with you as the most important channel in preparing for our meeting in Washington. There are only a few days before the New Year and I would like to convey to you and your spouse our warmest wishes.

M. Gorbachev
December 24, 1985

A few days into the new year, George Shultz began discussing with Ambassador Dobrynin the details for the next summit and we issued an invitation for Gorbachev to come to Washington in late June.

We got no reply to the invitation, although Gorbachev responded to my letter regarding human rights in the Soviet